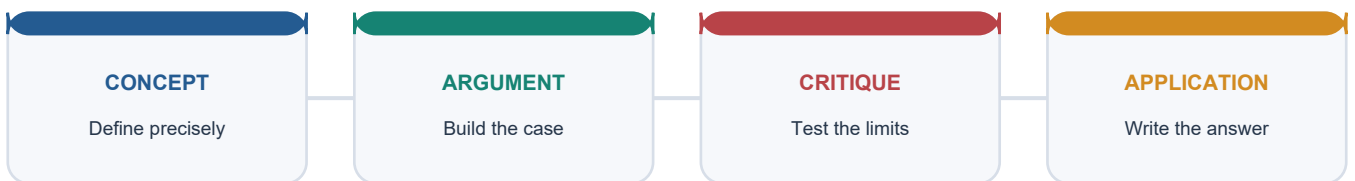


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Indian Cinema, Film Institutions and Awards - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC cinema workbook | 32 original MCQs, routed PYQ, full mains answers and current-status discipline

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Indian Cinema, Film Institutions and Awards - Solved Practice Workbook

REVISION BOX - CURRENT STATUS AND METHOD

- Checked on **6 September 2026**.
- **Latest official National Film Awards cycle located: 72nd National Film Awards for the year 2024**, announced in July 2026.
- **Latest officially announced Dadasaheb Phalke Award recipient located: Mohanlal for award year 2023**; do not invent a later recipient where no explicit official current statement was securely located in the approved bank.
- **IFFI discipline:** latest completed edition located here is the **56th** in Goa (closed **28 November 2025**); the **57th** edition is live as an upcoming official festival site for **November 2026**.
- **Boong discipline:** official BAFTA page verifies the **Children's & Family Film** category win; no Oscar claim is used without official Academy confirmation.
- **Merger discipline:** current MIB/PIB pages show the merged/transferred functions of **Films Division, DFF, NFAI and CFSI** into **NFDC**; keep training, archive, festival, certification and awards distinct by function.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement best explains why cinema belongs in the art-and-culture syllabus?

A. Cinema combines narrative, performance, moving image, sound and editing, then adds reproducibility and mass circulation as a modern art form. B. Cinema is only a branch of theatre because both use acting. C. Cinema belongs only to Economy because tickets are sold in markets. D. Cinema can be studied only through award lists.

Answer: A. Explanation: A is correct because it captures both composite form and modern circulation, which is the central thesis of Topic 15. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q2. Which option correctly defines mise-en-scene?

A. Only the soundtrack and background score. B. The arrangement within the frame, including setting, costume, lighting, performance and composition. C. A legal certificate for film exhibition. D. A branch of archive science dealing only with reels.

Answer: B. Explanation: B is correct because mise-en-scene concerns what is visibly arranged inside the frame rather than law, sound alone or archives. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q3. Which statement is safest about documentary film?

A. It becomes non-cinema because it deals with facts. B. It is automatically an unedited visual record. C. It remains a film form because non-fiction is still selected, framed and edited. D. It belongs only to television and not to cinema.

Answer: C. Explanation: C is correct because documentary retains cinematic framing and editing despite its non-fiction character. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q4. Which statement correctly distinguishes animation?

A. It is only a children's hobby outside film studies. B. It is merely still photography with no cinematic grammar. C. It becomes cinema only after a festival screens it. D. It is a moving-image form created through drawn, modelled or digitally generated frames.

Answer: D. Explanation: D is correct because animation is defined by frame-based moving-image construction, not by audience age or festival status. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q5. Which milestone belongs to the year 1896 in Indian cinema history?

A. Lumière screenings in Bombay introduced motion pictures to India. B. Raja Harishchandra was released as the first indigenous feature. C. Save Dada made two short films. D. The first cinema house in Madras was established.

Answer: A. Explanation: A is correct because 1896 marks first exhibition in Bombay, while the other milestones belong to later years. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q6. Which option is correctly matched with 1899?

A. Jamshedji Madan established Elphinstone Picture House. B. Harishchandra Bhatavdekar (Save Dada) made two short films as the first motion venture by an Indian. C. Alam-Ara became the first talkie. D. Fatma Begum directed Bulbul-e-Paristan.

Answer: B. Explanation: B is correct because Save Dada's 1899 shorts are the approved source-bank marker for the first motion venture by an Indian. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q7. Which statement is safest about Raja Harishchandra?

A. It was the first Indian-shot film of 1897. B. It was the first box-office hit of 1917. C. It was the first indigenous Indian silent feature, produced by Dadasaheb Phalke in 1913. D. It was the first indigenously made colour film.

Answer: C. Explanation: C is correct because Raja Harishchandra is the 1913 indigenous silent-feature milestone, distinct from 1897, 1917 and 1937 firsts. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q8. Which option correctly identifies the first box-office hit in the approved source bank?

A. Pundalik B. Alam-Ara C. Bulbul-e-Paristan D. Lanka Dahan

Answer: D. Explanation: D is correct because Lanka Dahan is separately identified as the first box-office hit and should not be merged with Phalke's 1913 feature milestone. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q9. Which statement best describes the relation between Pundalik and Raja Harishchandra?

A. Pundalik was an Indo-British collaboration of 1912, while Raja Harishchandra was the first indigenous Indian silent feature of 1913. B. Pundalik was the first indigenously made colour film and Raja Harishchandra the first talkie. C. Both were directed by Lakshmipriya Devi. D. Both belong to the 1952 Cinematograph Act era.

Answer: A. Explanation: A is correct because it keeps the 1912 collaboration distinct from the 1913 indigenous-feature milestone. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q10. Which option correctly identifies Fatma Begum's milestone?

A. She was India's first playback singer. B. She became the first Indian woman to produce and direct her own film, Bulbul-e-Paristan, in 1926. C. She founded the CBFC in 1950. D. She won the first Dadasaheb Phalke Award.

Answer: B. Explanation: B is correct because Fatma Begum's 1926 producer-director achievement is a history milestone, not a playback, regulatory or award first. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q11. Which statement is safest about the Indian Cinematograph Committee of 1927?

A. It organised the first IFFI. B. It created the BAFTA film awards. C. It was a colonial inquiry into censorship adequacy and the perceived immoral effect of films. D. It merged NFAI into NFDC.

Answer: C. Explanation: C is correct because the committee belongs to colonial regulation history and not to festivals, awards or modern mergers. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q12. Which option correctly pairs talkie history with a named individual?

A. Raja Harishchandra and W.M. Khan as first talkie pair. B. Premnagar and Jamshedji Madan as the first recorded-song pair. C. Kisan Kanya and Major Warwick as the talkie pair. D. Alam-Ara (1931), directed by Ardeshir Irani, with W.M. Khan associated with the first recorded song in Indian cinema.

Answer: D. Explanation: D is correct because the approved chronology links Alam-Ara, Ardeshir Irani and W.M. Khan to the first talkie and first recorded song route. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q13. Which statement is safest about Indian colour-film milestones?

A. Sairandhri (1933) was the first Indian colour film, while Kisan Kanya (1937) was the first indigenously made colour film. B. Kisan Kanya was the first talkie and Sairandhri the first studio-system film. C. Both Sairandhri and Kisan Kanya refer to the same milestone and may be used interchangeably. D. Neither film has any place in Indian cinema chronology.

Answer: A. Explanation: A is correct because the prelims trap lies in keeping the 1933 colour-processing milestone separate from the 1937 indigenous-colour one. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q14. Which option is correctly matched with industrial organisation in the approved source?

A. Lanka Dahan - first South Indian film. B. Devdas (1935) - first to use the studio system. C. Bulbul-e-Paristan - first colour film processed in Germany. D. Hunterwali - first film without any song.

Answer: B. Explanation: B is correct because Devdas is the source-bank studio-system marker, while the other pairings mismatch known firsts. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q15. Which statement is safest about Premnagar in the approved bank?

A. It was the first Indian colour film. B. It was the first box-office hit. C. It was the first South Indian film in the source chronology. D. It was the first National Film Award winner.

Answer: C. Explanation: C is correct because Premnagar appears as the source-owned anchor for early South Indian cinema in the 1939 row. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q16. Which option best captures parallel cinema in the approved source?

A. It emerged only after OTT platforms arrived. B. It refers only to imported foreign films shown in India. C. It was created by the CBFC to classify adults-only films. D. It emerged in the late 1940s as an alternative to mainstream commercial cinema, often focusing on poverty, injustice and human suffering.

Answer: D. Explanation: D is correct because parallel cinema is defined through social-realist themes and an alternative position vis-a-vis mainstream commercial cinema. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q17. Which statement is safest about cinema as social evidence?

A. Films show representation and public imagination, but they are not transparent measurements of social reality. B. Films are direct sociological surveys and should be read literally. C. Only documentaries can reflect social values. D. Cinema has no relation to identity or empathy.

Answer: A. Explanation: A is correct because this keeps the representational value of cinema while preserving the necessary qualification against literal social reading. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q18. Which option best supports the claim that Indian cinema is multilingual by structure?

A. The existence of a single national language for all films. B. The first South Indian film in the chronology, nine CBFC regional offices, and the need for fresh certification of dubbed versions. C. The rule that dubbed films need no fresh certification. D. The claim that only Hindi films reach rural areas.

Answer: B. Explanation: B is correct because these three facts together show cinema as a many-language field in production, regulation and circulation. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q19. Which statement correctly describes the role of the Central Board of Film Certification?

A. It is the country's principal film school in Pune. B. It is India's highest cinema award. C. It is a statutory body under MIB regulating public exhibition of films under the Cinematograph Act, 1952. D. It is the archive that preserves old reels.

Answer: C. Explanation: C is correct because CBFC belongs to certification, not awards, training or archival preservation. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q20. Which option correctly identifies the Board's composition as stated in the official/current bank?

A. Only one judge and one producer. B. Only state-government officers. C. Exactly 50 elected regional delegates. D. A chairman and non-official members numbering not less than 12 and not more than 25.

Answer: D. Explanation: D is correct because the CBFC page and source bank fix the chairman plus 12-25 non-official members structure. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q21. Which statement is safest about the certification-censorship distinction?

A. Certification classifies films for exhibition audiences, but the power to demand cuts or refuse sanction gives the scheme a censoring effect. B. Certification and censorship are identical because both use the letter C. C. Certification applies only to festival films. D. Censorship lies entirely outside film law.

Answer: A. Explanation: A is correct because the approved analytical line is certification in form but partly censoring in effect because exhibition can be conditioned or denied. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q22. Which option is correct about current appeals in the approved bank?

A. The FCAT remains the current appeal body. B. The safer current route is to note section 5C appeal to the High Court and not present FCAT as current. C. No appeal exists once the Board decides. D. All appeals go directly to BAFTA.

Answer: B. Explanation: B is correct because the canonical current-law update explicitly warns against treating FCAT as a live current tribunal. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q23. Which statement correctly identifies FTII?

A. It is the international award jury of IFFI. B. It is the statutory censorship board for films and web series. C. It was set up by the Government of India in 1960 under MIB and later registered as a society, making it a training institution rather than a regulator or archive. D. It replaced the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting.

Answer: C. Explanation: C is correct because FTII's functional identity is training, and this is the safe contrast the question tests. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q24. Which option is safest about SRFTI at the checked date?

A. It is a regional office of the CBFC. B. It is the body that grants BAFTA awards. C. It is the former name of NFAI. D. It is an autonomous film-training institution under MIB, established in 1995, and its official site records deemed-to-be-university status from April 2025.

Answer: D. Explanation: D is correct because SRFTI's official pages fix its training role, MIB connection and current deemed-status update. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q25. Which statement is safest about NFDC in the current institutional map?

A. It is a film-development corporation whose current official page also records the merger of functions of Films Division, DFF, NFAI and CFSI into it. B. It was created in 2026 exclusively to run film festivals. C. It is the same body as the CBFC. D. It certifies all dubbed films directly.

Answer: A. Explanation: A is correct because NFDC is the development corporation whose current architecture widened through the officially recorded merger of other film-media functions. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q26. Which option correctly explains the archival/preservation route?

A. Archives are unnecessary once a film wins an award. B. NFAI historically handled preservation, and preservation-related functions now sit within the consolidated NFDC-linked architecture. C. Preservation belongs only to state police departments. D. Film heritage does not decay materially.

Answer: B. Explanation: B is correct because this keeps both the legacy archive identity and the current consolidated institutional route without inventing extra detail. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q27. Which option correctly distinguishes the Dadasaheb Phalke Award?

A. It is a CBFC certification label for adults-only films. B. It is the same as the Best Feature Film award every year. C. It is India's highest award in cinema, instituted in 1969 and named after Dadasaheb Phalke. D. It is the title of the first talkie.

Answer: C. Explanation: C is correct because the Dadasaheb Phalke Award is a lifetime-honour distinction and not a certification or standard category prize. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q28. Which statement is safest about the National Film Awards at the checked date?

A. National Film Awards are the same as IFFI screening certificates. B. The latest cycle is still the 69th because later cycles do not exist. C. The latest cycle and the latest Dadasaheb Phalke recipient are necessarily announced together in every official page. D. The latest official cycle located is the 72nd National Film Awards for the year 2024, announced in July 2026.

Answer: D. Explanation: D is correct because the current official bank supports the 72nd-cycle announcement while also warning that Dadasaheb-recipient status may need separate verification. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q29. Which option is safest about Mohanlal's current Dadasaheb Phalke status in the approved official bank?

A. He is named in official MIB/PIB material as the Dadasaheb Phalke Award recipient for award year 2023. B. He is officially named as the 72nd-cycle recipient for 2024 in all pages located. C. He won a BAFTA Children's & Family Film award. D. He founded SRFTI.

Answer: A. Explanation: A is correct because the current official route names Mohanlal for award year 2023 and should not be stretched into a different unverified cycle claim. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q30. Which statement is safest about the International Film Festival of India at the checked date?

A. IFFI is the same as the Dadasaheb Phalke Award. B. The latest completed edition is the 56th in Goa, while the official site is already live for the upcoming 57th edition in November 2026. C. IFFI and BAFTA are the same institution. D. IFFI ended permanently in 2025.

Answer: B. Explanation: B is correct because the official IFFI site/news distinguish completed 2025 activity from the live upcoming 57th edition. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q31. Which option correctly states the verified official international claim for Boong?

A. Boong won the Academy Award for Best International Feature. B. Boong is the first Indian film ever to receive any foreign recognition. C. Boong won a BAFTA in the Children's & Family Film category, and the claim should stay category-specific. D. Boong has no verified international award connection at all.

Answer: C. Explanation: C is correct because the official BAFTA page supports the Children's & Family Film win, but wider Oscar or all-time claims are unsafe. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

Q32. Which statement is safest about Oscar claims for Boong?

A. Oscar claims are irrelevant because awards and institutions never matter in UPSC. B. Any BAFTA winner is automatically an Oscar winner. C. BAFTA and Academy Awards are the same body, so one claim proves the other. D. An Oscar claim should be withheld unless an official Academy source is located, because the approved bank verifies only the BAFTA category win.

Answer: D. Explanation: D is correct because the disciplined method is to separate BAFTA evidence from absent Academy evidence and withhold unstable expansion. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline.

VERIFIED OBJECTIVE / APPLICATION PYQS

PYQ 1. 2026 Prelims - Boong, BAFTA category and milestone claim

Consider the following statements with regard to the film 'Boong':

1. The film has recently won the British Academy of Film and Television Arts (BAFTA) Award in the Children's and Family Film category.
2. The film is directed by Lakshmi Priya Devi.
3. This is the first Indian film to win a BAFTA award in the Children's and Family Film category.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 3 only (c) 1 and 2 only (d) 3 only

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key. Concept analysis: Use statement-wise elimination only. BAFTA's official category page supports the Children's & Family Film win; the director is Lakshmi Priya Devi; and any 'first Indian film' claim must remain tied to that exact category rather than widened into a generic BAFTA or Oscar claim. The locally held 2026 key is provisional, so no option letter is printed.

DIRECT GS-I MAINS PYQ AUDIT NOTE

- No direct GS-I Mains PYQ is audited to Topic 15 ownership in the approved routing ledgers, so this workbook does **not** insert a fabricated 'direct solved mains PYQ' for cinema.

ORIGINAL MAINS ANSWERS

Original Q1. Why should cinema be treated as a modern Indian art form rather than as mere entertainment? (10 marks, 150 words)

Answer-grabbing introduction: Cinema belongs in Indian Art and Culture because it does what earlier art forms did - combine narrative, performance, music and visual design - while adding camera, editing and mass reproducibility.

Model solution

Cinema is a composite modern art. It fuses story or literature, acting, moving image, sound, music, colour and production design, and editing into one integrated medium. Its distinctive feature is not only combination but circulation: once recorded, a film can travel across regions and generations, creating common memory and public debate.

This medium also has a specifically Indian cultural history. From mythological silent features such as *Raja Harishchandra* to parallel cinema's social realism and the multilingual field of regional cinemas, cinema became a major vehicle of identity, empathy and representation. It also developed its own institutions - certification, training, archiving, awards and festivals - which older performance forms did not require in the same way.

Cinema should therefore be treated not as entertainment trivia but as a modern art that mediates aesthetics, technology and society together.

Conclusion: In UPSC terms, cinema matters because it is simultaneously art, archive, institution and public culture.

Original Q2. Trace the development of Indian cinema from exhibition to the talkie era. (10 marks, 150 words)

Answer-grabbing introduction: The development of Indian cinema is best understood through multiple firsts rather than one heroic starting point.

Model solution

Motion pictures entered India through Lumière screenings in Bombay in 1896. The process of indigenisation began quickly: *Coconut Fair and Our Indian Empire* appeared in 1897 as the first Indian-shot film, while Harishchandra Bhatavdekar, or Save Dada, made short films in 1899 as the first motion venture by an Indian. Cinema-house infrastructure developed with Major Warwick's Madras hall in 1900 and Jamshedji Madan's Elphinstone Picture House in Calcutta in 1907.

The silent era consolidated cinema as an Indian medium. *Pundalik* (1912) marked an Indo-British collaboration, and Dadasaheb Phalke's *Raja Harishchandra* (1913) became the first indigenous Indian silent feature. Silent films in India were accompanied by live music, showing early localisation of the medium. The 1930s then brought technical change: *Alam-Ara* (1931) became the first talkie.

Conclusion: Thus, Indian cinema evolved from imported exhibition to locally produced, institutionally grounded and linguistically transformative sound cinema within a few decades.

Original Q3. Distinguish certification from censorship in the Indian film-regulatory framework. (15 marks, 250 words)

Answer-grabbing introduction: India calls its film regime certification, but the powers exercised under it mean that censorship cannot be wished away from the analysis.

Model solution

Certification refers to legal classification for public exhibition. Under the Cinematograph Act, 1952, films are examined by the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC), a statutory body under the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting. The Board decides which audience may view a film and uses categories such as U, A and S, alongside age-linked UA markers in the current scheme.

Censorship, by contrast, concerns suppression, modification or restriction of content. In India, the distinction blurs because the Board may direct cuts, excisions or other modifications before granting a certificate. It may even refuse sanction for public exhibition if required changes are not made. Therefore the system is certification in formal structure, but partly censoring in effect.

Institutional detail matters. CBFC has a Chairman and non-official members appointed by the Central Government and functions through regional offices. The federal split is also important: certification is a Union subject, but enforcement within territories has involved state governments. The current caution is legal as well: FCAT should not be treated as a live current tribunal; the safer current statement is that specified appeals move through the High Court route under the updated framework.

Qualification: The full constitutional doctrine on free speech belongs to Polity. In Art and Culture, the focus is on the medium's regulation and cultural consequences.

Conclusion: Indian film regulation should therefore be described as audience-classification backed by content-control powers, not as a pure and harmless labelling system.

Original Q4. Discuss the institutional architecture of Indian cinema with special reference to training, preservation and development. (15 marks, 250 words)

Answer-grabbing introduction: Indian cinema has separate institutions because making films, certifying films, teaching filmmaking and preserving old films are different functions.

Model solution

The Ministry of Information and Broadcasting is the Union-level administrative anchor for the film sector. Under it, the CBFC handles statutory certification for public exhibition. But the institutional architecture widens beyond regulation.

Training is represented by Film and Television Institute of India (FTII), set up in 1960 under the Government of India, and Satyajit Ray Film and Television Institute (SRFTI), established in 1995 as an autonomous educational institution under the administrative control of MIB. Their function is pedagogic, not regulatory. They create trained film workers and filmmakers.

Preservation historically centred on the National Film Archive of India (NFAI), because film heritage is fragile and needs archiving, restoration, cataloguing and access. Development and promotion were associated with the National Film Development Corporation (NFDC), set up in 1975. Current official pages show that the functions of Films Division, Directorate of Film Festivals, NFAI and Children's Film Society of India were merged into NFDC under the consolidated architecture. This means that archive, documentary, children's cinema and festival functions now operate through a more integrated public structure.

The advantage of such consolidation is administrative synergy; the risk is dilution of specialist mandates, since archive logic differs from production logic.

Conclusion: Indian cinema's institutional map is therefore best written function-wise - certify, train, preserve, develop, exhibit and recognise - rather than as a flat acronym list.

Original Q5. Analyse cinema as a medium of nation-building and social representation in India. (20 marks, 250 words)

Answer-grabbing introduction: Cinema helped India imagine itself, but it did so through representation and mediation, not through neutral social reporting.

Model solution

Post-independence Indian cinema acquired a nation-building role because of its reach across urban and rural audiences and its ability to produce shared stories, emotions and symbols. It shaped public memory and gave visual form to ideas of family, reform, modernity, region and nation. This made cinema more than entertainment; it became a recurring site of identity formation.

At the same time, cinema is a medium of representation. It shows how filmmakers and producers imagined social tensions and what they believed audiences would accept. This is why it can illuminate reformist themes such as child marriage, women's education or social injustice without being mistaken for a direct social survey. The source's own periodisation of women on screen shows this clearly: reform themes, later stereotype, and then more complex depictions in parallel cinema.

Parallel cinema deepened this representational role by foregrounding poverty, injustice and human suffering. Figures such as Satyajit Ray, Ritwik Ghatak, Guru Dutt and Shyam Benegal in the approved bank help explain how cinema could serve as critique rather than only consensus.

Yet representation has limits. Commercial structures, censorship pressures, language markets and unequal access shape what reaches audiences. Therefore cinema can show changing public imagination without mirroring society perfectly.

Conclusion: Indian cinema's nation-building importance lies precisely in this tension - it reflects, shapes and debates social reality, but never transparently reproduces it.

Original Q6. Evaluate the role of festivals, awards and preservation in projecting Indian cinema globally. (20 marks, 250 words)

Answer-grabbing introduction: Global visibility in cinema is produced not only by famous films but by a chain of festivals, awards, archives and institutions that decide what travels and what survives.

Model solution

Festivals and awards give Indian cinema international visibility. The International Film Festival of India (IFFI) functions as a domestic international platform for exhibition, exchange and programming. National Film Awards and the Dadasaheb Phalke Award provide domestic recognition, while institutions such as BAFTA or the Academy Awards represent distinct international systems of recognition. These statuses are different: a certificate, a festival screening, a nomination and an award should never be merged.

The 2026 *Boong* route shows both possibility and caution. BAFTA's official category page verifies its win in the Children's & Family Film category, which is important for the visibility of Manipuri and Indian cinema. But the claim must remain category-specific; it should not be inflated into a general Oscar story or a proof of universal superiority. That distinction is analytically important.

Preservation is equally central to global projection. Films cannot travel across generations without archiving, restoration and digitisation. Here, institutions such as the NFAI legacy, NFHM and the current NFDC-linked preservation architecture matter because global presence depends not only on making films but also on keeping film heritage accessible.

However, external validation has limits. Festival circuits and juries recognise particular works in particular categories and do not exhaust the value of India's multilingual film cultures.

Conclusion: Indian cinema projects itself globally when recognition, curation and preservation work together - but prestige must always be analysed with category, institution and archival depth.